

# Along Reflection Questions

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# How to use

The Along reflection questions are research-aligned and created in partnership with many diverse organizations. We are excited to be able to share these for you to continue to use to spark conversations with your students.

- Search through the collections to determine questions that can help spark conversations with your students. **These conversations can help you learn more about who they are as individuals and help build a community in your classroom.**
- Use the questions in other tools that you regularly use to communicate with students, such as Google Classroom or Canvas. You can **copy and paste the questions** into those other tools.
- You can also **utilize our [Google Slides template](#)** to project individual questions up in your classroom as a do now or conversation starter. We have provided example questions on the slides and you can make a copy and edit or paste questions from this doc into the slides.

Note: As a reminder, when you open conversations with students please follow all local district policies and procedures if students share any sensitive information.

COLLECTION 1:

# Get acquainted and have fun, together

*Fun & favorites*

*A moment for gratitude*

*Conversation starters, from students*

*A day in the life*

*Imagine if*

GET ACQUAINTED AND HAVE FUN, TOGETHER

# Fun & favorites

*Open class warmly.*

## 1. When you want to relax, what do you like to watch?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- Something funny
- Something scary
- Something dramatic
- I like to relax in other ways.

## 2. What's something, or someone, that made you laugh recently? Why?

Author: Search Institute

## 3. Think about your favorite food. When do you most like to eat it?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- On special occasions
- As a treat on my own
- With family or friends
- Any time

## 4. Which of these desserts is best?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- Cookies
- Cake
- Pie
- None of these!

**5. Think about a song you really like. How do you feel when you listen to it?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- Energized
- Emotional
- Relaxed
- Something else

**6. Think about a favorite item of clothing. What makes it special?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- It's comfortable.
- There's a story about how I got it.
- I like the way it looks.
- I like something else about it.

**7. Who is someone you admire, or would like to meet? Why?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**8. What's your favorite animal? What do you like about them?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

GET ACQUAINTED AND HAVE FUN, TOGETHER

# A moment for gratitude

*Enjoy reflecting on the best in life.*

## 1. What is an activity you genuinely enjoy and look forward to?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- Sports or other physical activity
- Doing something creative
- Unwinding with a book or show
- Something else

## 2. Who makes you feel like your best self?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- A family member
- A friend
- A teacher or coach
- Someone else

## 3. Who are the people you feel lucky to have in your life?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

## 4. What's something you recently felt thankful for?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**5. What's something you really like (such as a food, a game, or a movie) that someone in your life introduced you to?**

Author: Search Institute

**6. Who in your life is the most fun for you to be with? Why?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**7. Who are the people who matter most to you in your life? Why?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**8. Who in your life do you want to make proud? Why?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

# Conversation starters, from students

*Open a thought-provoking dialogue, with questions written with high school students.*

## 1. What is something you feel like you're "too old" to do, but still enjoy?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

## 2. Which of the following wild animals would you choose for a pet?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- Kangaroo mouse
- Komodo dragon
- Kiwi bird
- None of the above

## 3. If you were a beverage, which would you want to be?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- Simple and refreshing (like lemonade)
- Warm and comforting (like hot tea)
- Satisfying and sweet (like a milkshake)
- Cool and crunchy (like a slushie)

#### **4. If you were an ice cream flavor, which would you want to be?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

##### **Answer choices:**

- A classic (like vanilla)
- A novelty (like birthday cake)
- Not-too-sweet (like green tea)
- Tropical and bold (like mango)

GET ACQUAINTED AND HAVE FUN, TOGETHER

# A day in the life

*Show students you care about their day-to-day.*

## 1. What do you usually do after school?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- An activity (like music or sports)
- Volunteer or paid work
- Go home or to a family member's home
- Something else

## 2. What is one thing that will brighten your day?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- A picture of a cute animal
- A really corny joke
- A moment to take a few deep breaths
- Something else

## 3. How are you feeling today?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- It's not a good day for me.
- I'm feeling okay.
- I'm feeling pretty good.
- Today is great!

**4. For you, what would be part of a perfect day?**

Author: Search Institute

**Answer choices:**

- A big, delicious breakfast
- Warm, sunny weather
- Unexpectedly seeing a friend
- Something else

**5. What's one thing that's on your mind today?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**6. What's one thing you'd like me to know about you today? Share how you're feeling, something that happened, or anything else.**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**7. What's something that other students might not know about you yet?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**8. Where do you go when you want to be by yourself? Why?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**9. What's an emotion you fear or dislike experiencing? Why?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**10. Who is someone who makes you feel better when you're down? How do they support you?**

Author: Search Institute

**11. How would you support a friend if they came to you for help with a problem?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**12. Think about a time when a friend was hurt or angry. How did you support them?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

GET ACQUAINTED AND HAVE FUN, TOGETHER

# Imagine if...

*Connect by daydreaming together.*

## 1. If we had “show-and-tell” in class, what would you bring?

Author: Search Institute

### Answer choices:

- Something someone gave me
- Something from a place I've visited
- Something I made myself
- Something from nature

## 2. If you could spend the day anywhere, where would it be?

Author: Search Institute

### Answer choices:

- Outside in nature
- Exploring a big city
- At home, doing something cozy
- Somewhere else

## 3. If you could time-travel, when would you visit?

Author: Character Lab

### Answer choices:

- The distant past (to see a dinosaur)
- The recent past (to see my ancestors)
- The future (to see what's new)
- I wouldn't want to time travel.

**4. If you could have a superpower, which of these would you want to be able to do?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- Turn invisible
- Fly like a bird
- Read peoples' minds
- Talk to animals

**5. If you could meet an imaginary animal, which would you choose?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- A lion the size of a mouse
- A mouse the size of a lion
- Neither one
- Both!

**6. If you could go any place in the world that you've never been to, where would you go? Why?**

Author: Search Institute

**7. If you could have a remote control for your life, which button would you want it to have?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- Pause (to slow down)
- Rewind (for a do-over)
- Fast forward (to skip ahead)
- Something else

**8. If you could be any age right now, what age would you be?**

Author: Search Institute

**Answer choices:**

- Younger than today
- A little older than today
- Much older than today
- I'd stay the same age.

COLLECTION 2:

# Connect to prior learning

*Math: previous experiences*

*Science: previous experiences*

*English: previous experiences*

*Social studies and history: previous experiences*

## CONNECT TO PRIOR LEARNING

# Math: previous experiences

*Learn about where students are coming from.*

### 1. What is one thing you enjoyed about your math class last year, or in a previous year?

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

#### Answer choices:

- A certain topic we covered
- A certain assignment we did
- Someone I got to work with
- Something else

### 2. What is one thing you wish there had been more of in your math class last year, or in a previous year?

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

#### Answer choices:

- Time to work together
- Assignments that related to my life
- Help when I got stuck
- Something else

### 3. Think about a time when you struggled with a math problem. What helped?

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

#### Answer choices:

- Talking to a classmate
- Taking a break, then trying again
- Looking at an example
- Something else, or I'm not sure

**4. Who is someone you think excels at math, either at school or somewhere else? How do you know they excel?**

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

## CONNECT TO PRIOR LEARNING

# Science: previous experiences

*Learn about where students are coming from.*

### 1. What is one thing you enjoyed about your science class last year, or in the previous year?

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

#### Answer choices:

- A certain topic we covered
- A certain assignment we did
- Someone I got to work with
- Something else

### 2. What is one thing you wish there had been more of in your science class last year, or in a previous year?

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

#### Answer choices:

- Time to work together
- Assignments that related to my life
- Help when I got stuck
- Something else

### 3. Think about a time when you struggled with science. What helped?

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

#### Answer choices:

- Talking to a classmate
- Taking a break, then trying again
- Looking at an example
- Something else, or I'm not sure

**4. Think about a science project or experiment you've done or seen. What tools or equipment were involved? What else do you remember?**

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

**5. Who is someone you think excels at doing science, either at school or somewhere else? How do you know they excel?**

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

## CONNECT TO PRIOR LEARNING

# English: previous experiences

*Learn about where students are coming from.*

### 1. What is one thing you enjoyed about your English class last year, or in the previous year?

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

#### Answer choices:

- A certain topic we covered
- A certain assignment we did
- Someone I got to work with
- Something else

### 2. What is one thing you wish there had been more of in your English class last year, or in a previous year?

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

#### Answer choices:

- Time to work together
- Assignments that related to my life
- Help when I got stuck
- Something else

### 3. Think about a time when you struggled with reading or writing. What helped?

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

#### Answer choices:

- Talking to a classmate
- Taking a break, then trying again
- Looking at an example
- Something else, or I'm not sure

**4. Think about any story that you read in the past year. What was most memorable about it?**

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

**5. Who is someone you think excels at writing, either at school or somewhere else? How do you know they excel?**

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

# Social studies and history: previous experiences

*Learn about where students are coming from.*

## **1. What is one thing you enjoyed about your social studies or history class last year, or in the previous year?**

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

### **Answer choices:**

- A certain topic we covered
- A certain assignment we did
- Someone I got to work with
- Something else

## **2. What is one thing you wish there had been more of in your social studies or history class last year, or in a previous year?**

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

### **Answer choices:**

- Time to work together
- Assignments that related to my life
- Help when I got stuck
- Something else

## **3. Think about a time when you struggled with social studies or history. What helped?**

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

### **Answer choices:**

- Talking to a classmate
- Taking a break, then trying again
- Looking at an example
- Something else, or I'm not sure

**4. Who is a person in history you've learned about before and still think about? Where did you first hear about them?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**5. Who is someone you think has a strong understanding of history and society? How do you know?**

Author: Black Teacher Collaborative

COLLECTION 3:

# Community, belonging, and affirmation

# Community, belonging, and affirmation

*Learn about where students are coming from.*

## 1. What's one thing that makes you feel part of a community?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- When people encourage me when I need it
- When people really listen to me
- When I work together with others
- Something else, or I'm not sure

## 2. What's one thing that makes you feel understood and appreciated?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- Sharing about myself and my culture
- Just being myself without questions
- Seeing other people I relate to
- Something else, or I'm not sure

## 3. What's one way you like to be recognized when you've worked hard?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- A shout-out in front of the class
- A note I can look at later
- A prize, like a sticker or badge
- Something else, or I'm not sure

**4. What's one thing you'd like us to try to make our class feel more like a community?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**5. What about you has been overlooked or not appreciated? What is important about that aspect of yourself?**

Author: Character Lab

**6. When have you shown someone you appreciate them? What was that like?**

Author: Character Lab

**7. Describe a time when you worked with others and felt like part of a community. What was that like?**

Author: Re-imagining migration

**8. Over time, have you found more people at school you enjoy working with? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, there still isn't anyone.
- A bit. I like one or two people now.
- Yes, there are more people I enjoy now.
- I've always had peers and adults I like.

COLLECTION 4:

# Rigorous learning and critical thinking

# Rigorous learning and critical thinking

*Promote growth and appropriately challenge students to be their best.*

**1. What do rigorous learning and critical thinking look like? What are you doing? What are you not doing?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**2. Think about a time when you noticed a teacher had high expectations for students. How did you know?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**3. What's a time when you've improved at something, even though it was hard at first? What was that like?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**4. Have you ever had someone encourage you to do something that was hard for you? What was that like?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**5. Is there something about the future that scares you? If so, what is it and why?**

Author: Search Institute

**6. When was the last time you made a mistake? What did you do to learn from that mistake?**

Author: Search Institute

**7. Think about the work you've done recently in class. How do you feel about it? What's one thing you're proud of?**

Author: Transcend

**8. Do you feel like you can get better at new things, even when they're hard at first? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I'm just not good at some things.
- I'm not sure.
- Maybe, but I need more help.
- Yes, I know I can improve.

**9. In our class, do you do things like explain your thinking and correct your mistakes? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I don't get to do that.
- Sometimes, but I run out of time.
- I should, but I don't always know how.
- Yes, I do that pretty often.

**10. In our class, do you learn something almost every day? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I mostly already know what we cover.
- I want to, but I get stuck.
- I usually learn something.
- Yes, I'm learning a lot.

**11. Over time, have you been able to explain your thinking and correct your mistakes more? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I still don't get to do that.
- A little bit more, but it's still hard.
- Yes, I can do this a lot more.
- I've always done this.

**12. Recently, have you learned something almost every day in class? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I'm still not learning a lot.
- I'm trying to learn, but I get stuck.
- Yes, I'm learning more than before.
- I've always learned a lot in our class.

**13. What's one thing that helps you tackle challenging work?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- Explaining my ideas to someone else
- Correcting my mistakes and trying again
- Time to figure it out on my own
- Something else, or I'm not sure

**14. What's one way you like teachers to show they have high expectations for you?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- Assigning me challenging work
- Telling me they know I can succeed
- Pushing me to keep improving
- Something else, or I'm not sure

**17. Think about the work you've done recently in class. How do you feel about it? What's one thing you're proud of?**

Author: Transcend

**18. What's one thing you'd like us to try to help you learn more in our class?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

COLLECTION 5:

# Relevance and motivation

# Relevance and motivation

*Support students to feel motivated and that learning matters for them.*

## **1. Does what we're learning in class matter to you? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

### **Answer choices:**

- No, I don't know why we learn this.
- Not much. A few things are interesting.
- A bit. I wish it felt more helpful.
- Yes, I think this will help me later.

## **2. Is what we're learning in class connected to your life or community? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

### **Answer choices:**

- No, I don't see any connection.
- No, we don't learn about people like me.
- If I try to, I can see a connection.
- Yes, it feels connected to me.

## **3. In our class, do we learn about important problems in the world? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

### **Answer choices:**

- No, we don't talk about big problems.
- A bit, but not what matters to me.
- Some. I wish we did it differently.
- Yes, we talk about things that matter.

**4. What's something you really care about that's connected to what we're learning?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**5. Over time, has what we're learning in class mattered more to you? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- I still don't know why we learn this.
- It matters to me a little more.
- Yes, I care more about it lately.
- What we learn always mattered to me.

**6. Lately, has what we've learned in class felt more connected to your life or community? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I still don't see any connection.
- I see more connection to my life.
- I see more connection to my community.
- It's always felt connected to me.

**7. Over time, have we learned more about important problems in the world? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, we don't talk about big problems.
- Some, but I'd still like more.
- Yes, we're doing this more.
- We've always done this.

**8. Over time, have you seen more connection between what we learn in class and what you really care about?**

Author: Transcend

COLLECTION 6:

# Wellbeing at school

# Wellbeing at school

*Support students to think about the social, emotional, and physical factors that impact learning.*

## **1. What does wellbeing mean to you? What does it look like or feel like?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

## **2. When do you feel most joyful? Why do you think that is?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

## **3. When do you feel most relaxed? What are you doing? Who are you with? Or, do you find alone time most relaxing?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

## **4. In our class, do we take steps to feel happy and healthy? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

### **Answer choices:**

- No, things we do make me more stressed.
- Not really. We don't talk about it.
- We do sometimes, but not enough.
- Yes, we do things to care for ourselves.

**5. In our class, do you learn ways to take care of yourself mentally and physically? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I don't know how to do that.
- No, I haven't learned about that here.
- A little bit, but I wish we did more.
- Yes, I've learned useful things to do.

**6. How would you describe your energy level today? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- I'm tired.
- I'm hanging in there.
- I'm good to go.
- Too high! I'm a little worked up.

**7. What would you most like us to do more of in class?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- Make time to be silly and have fun
- Take breaks to de-stress or relax
- Move around and be active
- Something else, or I'm not sure

### **8. How do you most like to be active?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

#### **Answer choices:**

- Outside, like by walking or biking
- To music, like by dancing or stretching
- With others, like by playing a sport
- Something else, or I'm not sure

### **9. How could we change our class to make it easier to manage stress?**

Author: Transcend

COLLECTION 7:

# Student agency and choice in learning

# Student agency and choice in learning

*Support students around building agency and making choices to drive learning.*

**1. In our class, do you have a say in what happens? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I don't have any say.
- Not really. My ideas aren't listened to.
- I have some say in what I do.
- Yes, my ideas are taken seriously.

**2. In our class, do you have the resources you need to support your learning? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I'm not sure what I need.
- I know what I need, but I can't get it.
- Sometimes I do, but not always.
- Yes, I have what I need.

**3. In our class, can you make choices to learn in the way that works best for you? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I can't try what I'd like to do.
- I'm not sure what change might help me.
- Sometimes I can do what's best for me.
- Yes, I make choices that help me learn.

**4. In our class, are you able to learn at your own pace? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, we move too fast for me.
- No, we move too slow for me.
- Sometimes I can, but not always.
- Yes, I can do what works for me.

**5. In our class, do assignments (like projects or tests) work well for you? Why or why not?**

Author: Transcend

**6. Is there anything about our class that you're struggling with? If so, what is it?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**7. Lately, do people want you to be happy and healthy (and not just get good grades)? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, only academics really matter here.
- We say it, but we still don't mean it.
- Yes, I've felt this way more recently.
- Yes, I've always felt this way.

**8. Over time, have you learned more ways to take care of yourself mentally and physically?  
Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I haven't learned that recently.
- A little bit, but I wish we did more.
- I've learned that somewhere else.
- Yes, I've gotten better at that here.

**9. What's one choice you like to have on assignments?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- Choosing my topic
- Choosing who I work with
- Choosing the format I use
- Something else, or I'm not sure

**10. What do you wish you had more of a say about in class?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- What topics we learn about
- The types of activities we do
- The pace we work at
- Something else, or I'm not sure

**11. What's one thing that helps you learn in class? Why?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**12. What's one thing we could change in class to make it easier to focus? Why?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**13. What's one choice you'd like to have in class to better support your learning? Why?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**14. Over time, have you had more say in what happens in class? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I don't get to share my ideas.
- No, my ideas aren't listened to.
- Yes, my ideas are listened to more.
- I've always had a say in what happens.

**15. Over time, have you had more access to resources you need to support your learning? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- I still don't know what would help me.
- I know what I need, but I can't get it.
- Yes, I get what I need more often.
- I've always gotten what I need.

**16. Over time, have you had more flexibility to learn in the way that works best for you? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- I still can't try what I'd like to do.
- I'm still not sure what to try.
- Yes, I can do this more often.
- I've always been able to do what I need.

**17. Over time, have you been more able to learn at your own pace? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, the pace still isn't right for me.
- I have a bit more often.
- Yes, I can now learn at my pace.
- I've always been able to do what I need.

**18. Lately, have assignments in class (like projects or tests) worked well for you? Why or why not?**

Author: Transcend

**19. Lately, is there anything in our class that you're struggling with? What is it?**

Author: Transcend

COLLECTION 8:

# Building Blocks for Learning

*Activating Agency*

*Cultivating Curiosity*

*Building Resilience*

*Unlocking Self-Direction*

*Pathways to Purpose*

# Activating Agency

*Support students in taking meaningful action, finding personal value in learning, and building confidence in their unique identities, backgrounds, and abilities.*

## 1. What's one choice you like to have on assignments?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- Choosing my topic
- Choosing who I work with
- Choosing the format I use
- Something else, or I'm not sure

## 2. What do you wish you had more of a say about in class?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- What topics we learn about
- The types of activities we do
- The pace we work at
- Something else, or I'm not sure

## 3. What's one choice you'd like to have in class to better support your learning? Why?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**4. In our class, do you have a say in what happens? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I don't have any say.
- Not really. My ideas aren't listened to.
- I have some say in what I do.
- Yes, my ideas are taken seriously.

**5. In our class, do you have the resources you need to support your learning? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I'm not sure what I need.
- I know what I need, but I can't get it.
- Sometimes I do, but not always.
- Yes, I have what I need.

**6. In our class, can you make choices to learn in the way that works best for you? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I can't try what I'd like to do.
- I'm not sure what change might help me.
- Sometimes I can do what's best for me.
- Yes, I make choices that help me learn.

**7. Over time, have you had more say in what happens in class? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I don't get to share my ideas.
- No, my ideas aren't listened to.
- Yes, my ideas are listened to more.
- I've always had a say in what happens.

**8. What does it mean to you to have agency, or choice, in your learning?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**9. Think about a time when you took initiative. How did it feel to start something yourself?**

Author: Character Lab

**10. What does it mean to you to have a "growth mindset"? What does it feel like? How does it change your actions?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**11. When has someone helped you grow academically? What did they do?**

Author: Search Institute

**12. What's one thing that makes you feel understood and appreciated?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- Sharing about myself and my culture
- Just being myself without questions
- Seeing other people I relate to
- Something else, or I'm not sure

**13. What's something you're looking forward to? It can be big or small, soon or far in the future.**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**14. In our class, are you included and part of a community? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I don't have any strong ties.
- Not really. I wish I was more connected.
- Sometimes, but it depends on the day.
- Yes, people make me feel like I belong.

# Cultivating Curiosity

*Nurture curiosity by helping students connect learning to their lives, manage stress, and explore diverse perspectives with empathy and self-awareness.*

## 1. If we had “show-and-tell” in class, what would you bring?

Author: Search Institute

### Answer choices:

- Something someone gave me
- Something from a place I've visited
- Something I made myself
- Something from nature

## 2. What’s one thing you’d like us to try to make our class feel more like a community?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

## 3. Lately, has what we've learned in class felt more connected to your life or community? Pick what’s closest to how you feel.

Author: Transcend

### Answer choices:

- No, I still don’t see any connection.
- I see more connection to my life.
- I see more connection to my community.
- It’s always felt connected to me.

## 4. Over time, have you seen more connection between what we learn in class and what you really care about?

Author: Transcend

**5. What's something you're looking forward to? It can be big or small, soon or far in the future.**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**6. How are you feeling about what's coming up soon in school? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

**Answer choices:**

- Nervous
- Optimistic
- Stressed
- Something else, or I'm not sure

# Building Resilience

*Empower students to recover and adapt from challenges, persevere toward goals, build lasting emotional connections, and embrace growth through effort and support*

**1. When was the last time you made a mistake? What did you do to learn from that mistake?**

Author: Search Institute

**2. Think about the work you've done recently in class. How do you feel about it? What's one thing you're proud of?**

Author: Transcend

**3. Have you ever had someone encourage you to do something that was hard for you? What was that like?**

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

# Unlocking Self-Direction

*Guide students to set goals, take action, and reflect, to build flexibility and awareness.*

## 1. What helps you focus when you're working?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- Listening to calm music
- Something to fidget with
- Peace and quiet
- Something else, or I'm not sure

## 2. What's one choice you'd like to have in class to better support your learning? Why?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

## 3. In our class, are you able to learn at your own pace? Pick what's closest to how you feel.

Author: Transcend

### Answer choices:

- No, we move too fast for me.
- No, we move too slow for me.
- Sometimes I can, but not always.
- Yes, I can do what works for me.

**4. In our class, do you have the resources you need to support your learning? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, I'm not sure what I need.
- I know what I need, but I can't get it.
- Sometimes I do, but not always.
- Yes, I have what I need.

**5. Over time, have you had more flexibility to learn in the way that works best for you? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- I still can't try what I'd like to do.
- I'm still not sure what to try.
- Yes, I can do this more often.
- I've always been able to do what I need.

**6. Over time, have you been more able to learn at your own pace? Pick what's closest to how you feel.**

Author: Transcend

**Answer choices:**

- No, the pace still isn't right for me.
- I have a bit more often.
- Yes, I can now learn at my pace.
- I've always been able to do what I need.

**7. Think about a time when you took initiative. How did it feel to start something yourself?**

Author: Character Lab

# Pathways to Purpose

*Help students set meaningful goals, understand themselves deeply, and connect confidently with their communities.*

## 1. What's one thing that makes you feel understood and appreciated?

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning

### Answer choices:

- Sharing about myself and my culture
- Just being myself without questions
- Seeing other people I relate to
- Something else, or I'm not sure

## 2. What's something you're looking forward to? It can be big or small, soon or far in the future.

Author: Chan Zuckerberg Initiative/Gradient Learning